

Table of contents

Introduction

TOPIC 1: Occupational Health and Safety

TOPIC 2: Hazard Identification

TOPIC 3: Risk Assessment

TOPIC 4: Risk Control

ASSIGNMENT!

Introduction



Occupational Health and Safety or *OHS* is concerned with health, safety, and welfare issues in the workplace. Policies and procedures are important in discussing OHS because it aims to make the workplace **safer and better** for workers and stakeholders.

It is concerned with many factors such as removal of hazards and reducing accidents in the workplace.

As a future computer technician, it is your **responsibility** to know these standard protocols especially since you will be assembling and repairing expensive and sensitive equipment that need care and proper handling.

TOPIC 1: Occupational Health and Safety

Occupational Health and Safety (OHS) is a set of policies and procedures that is followed in a workplace in order to *prevent accidents, illnesses, and injuries*.

It involves knowing the risks that can be encountered in a workplace and figuring out how it can be prevented.

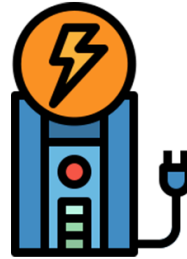
Following OHS policies and procedures is important when dealing with electronics since it would protect not only the personnel dealing with the components, but also the unit itself.

Three steps may be done to facilitate OHS procedures in a CSS work space:

1. Hazard identification
2. Risk assessment
3. Risk control

In addition to that, here are some additional OHS Procedures that must be observed in computer servicing:

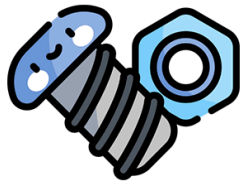
Do not remove computer parts while it is still plugged on its power source.



Remove all jewelry and other accessories while working.

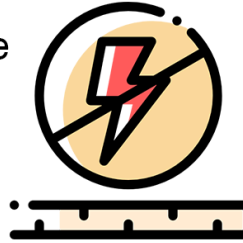
Avoid bringing liquids inside the workplace.





Avoid overtightening screws.

Wear an anti-static device to prevent electrostatic discharge.



Use shoes with non-conductive rubber soles to reduce risks of being shocked.

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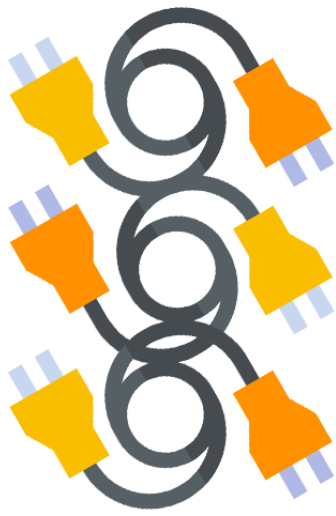
TOPIC 2: Hazard Identification

Hazards are anything that can hurt a person. Example of hazards that can be encountered when conducting computer systems servicing are:

- Tangled electrical cords
- Unsecured or unevenly stacked boxes
- Noise

Hazard identification involves observing the workplace's surroundings to recognize potential risks.

What are common hazards that can be encountered in the electronic industry?



1 PHYSICAL HAZARDS

Physical hazards can be further classified as an occupational or an environmental hazard.

A common type of physical hazard are cables tangled across the floor. It can cause someone to trip and fall. These can be addressed by making sure that the workspace is in a clean and proper condition.

MECHANICAL HAZARDS 2

Mechanical hazards can either be a result from manual use of tools or powered equipment.

An example of this is getting entangled with tools and equipment used in the workplace that may lead to injuries.



3 CHEMICAL HAZARDS

This is caused by exposure to chemicals in the workplace. Chemical hazards should be prevented as it can cause long-term harmful health issues.

In electronics, different chemicals will be used such as cleaning chemicals, dust removers, cleaning solvents, oil, and others that is why it is important to be careful.

ELECTRIC SHOCK HAZARDS 4

An electrical hazard is a dangerous condition that can be caused by direct electrical contact from an active equipment or electrical conductor.





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TOPIC 3: Risk Assessment



Assessing the risk is evaluating how a hazard would harm a person.

While hazards are what can harm the person, risk is the possibility of the hazard harming someone.

Two questions can be asked to assess a risk:

1

How likely will the hazard harm me or someone else?

2

How damaging will the risk be?

TOPIC 4: Risk Control

Once the hazard has been identified and its risks have been evaluated, it is time to address these issues:

- Ask your supervisor for instruction and training before using or repairing an equipment.
- Do not carry or move heavy objects by yourself.



PHYSICAL HAZARDS

One can use gaffers tape to manage and organize cables that need to run across the floor for a long period of time. Gaffers tape is a strong adhesive that can stick to the floor in order to minimize disarray of computer cables.

Besides this, cable ties, cable wraps, and cable raceways can be used for long term cable routing.



MECHANICAL HAZARDS

In general, mechanical hazards can be prevented by ensuring that all equipment are well maintained. In addition to that, a person must be well trained or supervised before using an unfamiliar equipment.

Use equipment in the way the manufacturer had initially intended.



CHEMICAL HAZARDS

In order to prevent chemical hazards, make sure to properly check labels of chemicals that will be used.

Be on the lookout for flammable substances.

Make sure to follow safety procedures indicated on product labels or packaging.



ELECTRIC SHOCK HAZARDS



To minimize risks, make sure to check for faulty wiring before use.

Do not disconnect power cords by tugging on the wire. Instead, hold the plug end when disconnecting.

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ASSIGNMENT!

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Choose an industry or any type of workplace that makes use of computers or electronics (e.g. computer laboratory, computer shop, stores, etc.). You can also do this activity in your own home/personal computer.

Observe the surroundings and make a list of hazards that may be present in the workplace. Describe the risks.

Write down possible interventions to control the risks.



Note: No need to submit! However we still encourage you to do this on your own.

